HILCHOT SHABBAT

Yad Soledet Bo, Salt & Placing Food Near Fire: Hilchot Shabbat

Given Thursday 12 March 2026 · Siman 318, Seifim 6-14

Siman: 318 (Bishul — Cooking on Shabbat) **Seifim:** 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 13, 14, 15 **Topics:** Yad Soledet Bo Defined, Stacking Pots & Hatmanah, Placing Food on an Urn, Salt & Kli Rishon, Irui Kli Rishon, Why Kli Sheni Doesn't Cook, Placing Near Fire, Davar Gush

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Recap: Where We Are in Siman 318

- **Seifim 1–2:** Ma'aseh Shabbat — consequences of desecrating Shabbat; cooking for a choleh
- **Seif 3:** Cooking in the sun / toldot hachamah; microwave; dud shemesh
- **Seif 4:** Major seif — bishul from ma'achal Ben Drosai; bishul achar bishul b'lach; Rema's position; kli sheni; irui kli rishon; kalei habishul; kli shlishi
- **Seif 5:** Bishul achar afiyah — cooking after baking; toast, coffee, tea bags, tea leaves

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Yad Soledet Bo — The Threshold of Bishul (Full Treatment)

- The single most important measurement in all of Hilchot Bishul
- Every question about whether something constitutes bishul on Shabbat depends on this threshold

Definition in the Gemara — Two Formulations

your hand is scalded by it (adult) — **יד סולדת בו**

the stomach of a baby is burnt by it (more tender) — **כריסו של תינוק נכוית**

- Note: scalding (adult) vs. burning (baby) — different severity, same temperature
- Both describe the same threshold from different perspectives

The Ben Ish Chai's Practical Test

- Problem: you can't use a thermometer on Shabbat — how do you assess?
- Ben Ish Chai's guideline (accepted by Chacham Ovadia and many poskim):
- **Can eat/drink it freely** → NOT yad soledet bo
- **Would refrain because too hot** → IS yad soledet bo
- Example: boiling tea you need to blow on and wait = still yad soledet bo
- Once you can sip freely and comfortably = below yad soledet bo

The Temperature in Degrees

Posek	Temperature
Chacham Ben-Tzion Abba Shaul	40°C
Rav Shlomo Zalman Auerbach	45°C
Chacham Ovadia Yosef	45°C (quotes 40°C but seems to take on 45°C)
Rav Moshe Feinstein (maximum)	71°C

- **Accepted minimum:** 45°C
- **Accepted maximum:** 71°C
- True yad soledet bo is somewhere in that range

Why 40°C Is Difficult to Accept

- People sit comfortably in mikvah water at 43°C (some mikva'ot in London display temperature)
- If people relax in 43°C water, hard to say 40°C is "scalding"
- **Rav Falk's response** (heard in shiur in Gateshead): our bodies have changed due to modern heating and constant hot water exposure — resistance to heat has increased. What was scalding at 40°C may no longer feel scalding to us, but halachically remains yad soledet bo
- Interesting idea, but majority of poskim take on 45°C

Proof from Gemara That ~40°C Is Not Yad Soledet Bo

- Gemara in Chullin: חם בית השחיטה צונן — warmth at the slaughter site (body temperature, ~37–40°C) is halachically "cold" (צונן)
- Has ramifications for kashrut (kashering knives)
- Demonstrates that 40°C and below = not yad soledet bo

The Critical Two-Direction Application

The 45°C–71°C range creates a zone of uncertainty. Direction matters:

Direction 1 — For stringency (putting something cold into hot liquid):

- Use the **minimum** — 45°C
- From 45°C upward, assume it may be yad soledet bo → capable of bishul
- Liquid at 50°C? → Cannot put uncooked items into it

Direction 2 — For leniency (is my liquid still "hot enough" to reheat?):

- Use the **maximum** — 71°C
- Must be at least 71°C to be certain it's still yad soledet bo
- Liquid dropped to 60°C? → Cannot be sure it's above yad soledet bo → cannot reheat
- Liquid at 80°C? → Certainly still yad soledet bo → can reheat

Quick reference:

Scenario	Ruling
Soup cooled to 55°C — can I reheat?	**No** — may be below yad soledet bo (could be as high as 71°C)
Soup still at 80°C — can I reheat?	**Yes** — certainly still yad soledet bo
Liquid at 40°C — any concern?	**No** — below minimum threshold by all opinions

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Seif ו (Vav): Placing a Hot Pot on Top of a Covered Pot

The Scenario

- One pot already insulated/covered with a towel (hatmanah)
- Another pot with hot liquid (still yad soledet bo) you want to keep warm
- Can you place the second pot under the same covering, on top of the first?

The Halacha — Permitted

כלי שיש בו דבר חם שהיד סולדת בו מותר להניחו בשבת על גבי קדרה הטמונה כדי שישמור חמו ולא יצטנן

- A vessel with hot liquid (yad soledet bo) may be placed on top of a covered pot to retain its heat

Hatmanah Background

- Generally: cannot fully wrap/insulate food on Shabbat, even with materials that don't add heat
- **Key principle:** If something is already covered, you may add to it
- Since the first pot is already insulated → adding the second pot under the existing insulation = permitted
- Also mentioned: can seal pot opening with dough if no lid (dough must be kneaded before Shabbat) — less relevant today

The Restriction — Cooled Liquids

אבל אין מניחים כלי שיש בו דבר שאינו חם כל כך...

- If the liquid in the top pot is **no longer yad soledet bo** → **cannot** place on top of a hot pot where it could be heated back to yad soledet bo
- Reason: yesh bishul achar bishul b'lach — cooled liquid is subject to further bishul
- **Exception:** If the bottom pot can only warm it slightly (not to yad soledet bo) → permitted

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Seif ז (Zayin): Even If the Bottom Pot Is on the Fire

The Question

- We've established stacking pots is fine
- But what if the bottom pot is on the fire?
- Isn't placing the top pot essentially "putting food on the fire" on Shabbat?

Two Opinions

First opinion (halacha follows):

- Even if the bottom pot is on the fire → permitted

- The intervening pot = clear separation (hefsek)
- **Better** than garuf v'katum:
- Garuf v'katum = covered flame — a thin separation
- Whole pot in between = obvious, unmistakable separation
- Clear heker (indication) → won't come to cook or stoke

Second opinion:

- Having bottom pot on fire = same as partial cover
- Cannot place food on a partial cover for the first time on Shabbat

Shulchan Aruch rules like the first opinion.

Seif ח (Chet): Same Principle for Solids

- Same two opinions applied to **dry, fully cooked solids**
- Shulchan Aruch again rules like the first opinion: permitted
- **Caveat:** If food has any liquid (מרק/רוטב) that is not yad soledet bo but could reach it from the heat below → **forbidden according to all opinions**

Practical Application: Placing Food on an Urn

- Urn = water on a fire (the heating element)
- The urn itself = "bottom pot on the fire"
- Placing food on top of the urn = exactly this scenario

Rulings:

What You're Placing	On the Urn?
Dry, fully cooked solids	**Yes** — always fine, even if reaches yad soledet bo
Liquid still yad soledet bo (piping hot)	**Yes** — not subject to further bishul
Liquid cooled below yad soledet bo	**Only if** urn surface cannot bring it to yad soledet bo
Fully cold liquid (from fridge)	**Only if** urn surface cannot bring it to yad soledet bo

Plastic urn lid (standard white UK urn):

- Rabbi Kada's assessment: cold liquids on plastic lid likely cannot reach yad soledet bo
- Therefore: permitted to place cold liquids to warm them

Metal urn lid:

- May conduct enough heat → cold liquids could reach yad soledet bo
- Must ensure: dry solid, or still yad soledet bo, or confirm surface isn't hot enough

Additional point: Even if the urn element were considered a "naked flame" (most poskim say it isn't), you could still put food on top — the urn acts as the intervening pot (hefsek), exactly as in these seifim.

Seif ט (Tet): Kli Rishon Cooks Even Off the Fire

כלי ראשון אפילו לאחר שהעבירו מעל האש מבשל כל זמן שהיד סולדת בו

- Kli rishon = the original pot food was cooked in
- Retains cooking ability even off the fire, as long as yad soledet bo
- Cannot put spices or anything uncooked into it
- Practical picture: pot of soup off the hotplate, lid closed → stays boiling hot 30+ minutes → full kli rishon status the whole time

Important Point Many People Don't Realize

- **Kli rishon on the fire** → cooks everything
- **Kli rishon off the fire** → does NOT cook everything
- The Gemara states clearly: **meat of an ox** (בשר שור) — very tough meat — **cannot be cooked** in a kli rishon off the fire
- The pot doesn't have enough sustained heat without the fire to cook such tough meat
- Everyone agrees on this

The Two Versions About Salt

Two lishnas (versions) of Rav Nachman's statement:

First version (lishna kamma):

- Salt = the opposite extreme from ox meat
- Salt is **kalei habishul** — so easy to cook, it can cook in conditions weaker than a normal kli rishon
- Cannot put salt even where you'd normally be lenient

Second version (lishna batra):

- Salt is **like ox meat** — extremely hard to cook
- Just as ox meat can go in a kli rishon off the fire → salt can too

Rule of psak: When Gemara has two versions → halacha follows **lishna batra** (second version)

Shulchan Aruch's Ruling

אבל מלח מותר ליתן לתוכו כיון שהעבירו מעל האש דצריכא מלחא בישולא כבשרא דתורא

- Rambam, Rif, Rosh all follow the second version
- **Salt may be placed in a kli rishon off the fire** — needs as much cooking as ox meat
- Rabbi Kada tried to find scientific info on whether salt is easy or hard to cook — didn't find much

The Rema's Position (Ashkenazim)

- Tosfot preferred the first version (salt = kalei habishul)
- The Rema brings this:

ויש אוסרים ליתן מלח אפילו בכלי שני... והמחמיר תבוא עליו ברכה

- "One who is strict will be blessed" = main halacha permits it, but good to be machmir

Summary: Salt on Shabbat

Community	Kli Rishon on Fire	Kli Rishon off Fire	Kli Sheni
Sefardim	Forbidden	**Permitted**	Permitted
Ashkenazim (main halacha)	Forbidden	**Permitted**	Permitted
Ashkenazim (machmir)	Forbidden	Permitted	**Praiseworthy to avoid**

Be'dieved: Salt Put on the Fire

ואם עבר ונתן מלח אפילו בכלי ראשון אפילו הוא על האש מותר המאכל דהמלח בטל

- If you transgressed and put salt even in a kli rishon **on the fire** → food is still permitted
- Reason: salt is batel (nullified) — less than 1/60th of the food

The Difficulty: Avid L'ta'ama

- Major principle in kashrut: **דבר העביד לטעמא לא בטל** — something added for taste is never nullified, even less than 1/60th
- Salt = the quintessential example of something added for taste!
- So how can the Rema say it's batel?

Resolution (acharonim):

- Must be talking about food **already partially salted before Shabbat**
- Principle of **zeh v'zeh gorem** (combined causes): original salt from before Shabbat + new Shabbat salt together produce the taste
- Forbidden element (Shabbat salt) is not the sole cause → bitul applies

If food was NOT salted before Shabbat:

- Salt = avid l'ta'ama → NOT batel
- Food subject to full ma'aseh Shabbat rules (Seif Aleph):
- Intentional (meizid): violator may never eat it; others may eat after Shabbat
- Unintentional (shogeg): no one eats on Shabbat; everyone eats after Shabbat

Other Opinion on Meat

- Some say: although ox meat can't be cooked in kli rishon off fire, the **moisture/liquid** inside it can be cooked → therefore forbidden
- **Not followed** — main halacha permits placing hard meat in kli rishon off the fire

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Seif י (Yud): Irui Kli Rishon — Pouring from a Kli Rishon

אסור ליתן תבלין בקערה ולערות עליהם מכלי ראשון

- Forbidden to put anything in a bowl and pour onto it from a kli rishon
- Follows Rabbeinu Tam (over Rashbam): irui kli rishon has cooking ability

Key details:

- Irui cooks **kdei klipa** — one layer/peel. Less powerful than a full kli rishon but still constitutes bishul

- **For Shabbat:** Any cooking = forbidden de'oraita, so kdei klipa makes no practical difference
- **For kashrut:** Matters — irui only affects the outer layer (transfer of taste between meat/milk etc.)
- **For Pesach:** Same — pouring hot chametz liquid onto a surface affects only kdei klipa

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Seif י"ג (Yud Gimmel): Putting Cold Water in a Kli Sheni

מותר ליתן קיתון של מים בכלי שני שיש בו מים חמים אבל בכלי ראשון אסור

- Cold water (even in a bottle) → **permitted** in a kli sheni
- Cold water → **forbidden** in a kli rishon (even off the fire)

Why the Gemara Specifies a Bottle (Kiton)

- Could have just said "you can put cold water in a kli sheni" — why mention a bottle?
- **Chiddush is on the kli rishon side:** You might think the bottle insulates and the water inside can't cook
- Gemara teaches: **no** — even water in a bottle, in a kli rishon off the fire, can be heated to yad soledet bo → forbidden
- In a kli sheni — with or without bottle — fine, because כלי שני אינו מבשל

Why Doesn't Kli Sheni Cook? (Tosfot's Explanation)

- Fundamental question: water in a kli sheni can still be 80–90°C
- Pour from urn into cup → temperature drops maybe 1–3°C → still boiling hot
- A child's stomach would certainly be burnt → so why doesn't it cook?

Tosfot's answer:

- Cooking involves not just the liquid's temperature but also **the walls of the pot**
- Fire heats both the liquid AND the walls → walls contribute additional cooking power from all sides
- Once transferred to kli sheni → new walls were **never heated by fire**
- Cold walls being warmed by the liquid ≠ fire-heated walls
- Liquid is hot but lacks the reinforcement of fire-heated walls → no full cooking ability

Scientifically: Difficult to explain — temperature difference between kli rishon and kli sheni is minimal. But this is the accepted halachic reasoning and the basis for the entire kli rishon/sheni/shlishi framework.

Seif י"ד (Yud Daled): Placing Food Near the Fire

מותר ליתן קיתון של מים כנגד האש להפיג צינתן ובלבד שיתנם רחוק... שאינו יכול להתחמם... עד שתהא יד סולדת בו

- You may place food/liquid **near** a fire to warm it
- **Condition:** far enough that it **cannot** reach yad soledet bo even if left indefinitely

Background: Why "Near" Is Different from "On"

- Rabbinically: can't put food on the fire on Shabbat (even fully cooked)
- Reason 1: may come to stoke coals (מחתה בגחלים)
- Reason 2: looks like cooking (מחזי כמבשל)
- **Near** the fire (not on it) → doesn't trigger these concerns
- Doesn't look like cooking

- Won't come to stoke
- No rabbinic prohibition
- **But:** May still be a Torah prohibition of bishul if food can reach yad soledet bo from radiated heat

The Critical Rule: Even for a Short Time

אבל אסור לקרבו אל האש למקום שיכול להתחמם שתהא יד סולדת בו ואפילו להניח בו שעה קטנה

- **Cannot** place anything where it **could** reach yad soledet bo
- Even if you intend to remove it before it gets that hot
- Even "a short time" to just take the chill off = **forbidden**
- Reason: concerned you'll forget — get distracted, answer the door, start a conversation → food reaches yad soledet bo

Practical examples:

Scenario	Ruling
Next to a radiator → warms to 30°C, cannot reach 45°C	**Mutar**
Next to a roaring fireplace → could reach yad soledet bo in 30 min	**Asur** — even if you plan to remove in 5 min
On a windowsill in direct sun → gets warm but not yad soledet bo	**Mutar** (also: cooking in sun itself is permitted per Seif Gimmel)

The Rema: Fruit and Raw Edible Foods

הוא הדין בפירות ושאר דברים הנאכלים כמות שהן חיים

- Even fruit and items edible raw are subject to bishul
- Cooking improves them (apple → baked apple)
- Cannot place where they could reach yad soledet bo
- **Sha'ar HaTziyun:** cooking already-edible food is most likely **de'oraita** (cooking transforms and improves = meaningful bishul)

Towels on Radiators (Sha'ar HaTziyun)

- **Dry towel on a radiator:** Permitted
- Even if it could get very hot
- Reason: if it gets too hot → gets ruined/burnt → you won't forget to remove it
- Natural built-in reminder
- **Wet towel on a radiator:** Forbidden
- Water in the towel = subject to bishul
- Also: drying a wet garment on a radiator may involve **melabein** (laundering) — heat helps remove absorbed substances

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Seif ט"ו (Tet Vav): Dry, Fully Cooked Solids Near the Fire

דבר שנתבשל כל צרכו והוא יבש... מותר להניחו כנגד המדורה אפילו במקום שהיד סולדת בו

- Fully cooked **dry solid** → may be placed near the fire **even where it can reach yad soledet bo**

Two reasons this is permitted:

1. **No bishul issue:** אין בישול אחר בישול for solids — already fully cooked
2. **No shehiyah issue:** Next to the fire, not on it — shehiyah doesn't apply

ואפילו נצטנן כבר

- Even if **already cooled down completely** → dry solids are not subject to further bishul
- Can take cold schnitzel and place right next to a roaring fireplace → perfectly fine

Practical application: Holiday house with a fireplace on Shabbat — place fully cooked dry chicken, schnitzel, kugel etc. next to the fire freely. But NOT cooled soup, gravy, or dishes with significant liquid.

The Rema on Liquids Near the Fire

ונהגו להקל בזה אם לא נצטנן לגמרי

- Reiterates his position from Seif Dalet
- Ashkenazim: if liquid is still lukewarm (poshrim, ~27–30°C) → may place near fire
- If fully cold → may not (even next to the fire — liquid could reach yad soledet bo)

A Question from the Shiur: Food on the Fire Before Yad Soledet Bo

Robert's question: Put uncooked food in a kli rishon on the fire, water only 25–30°C, realize mistake and take off — have you committed an aveirah?

For Solids

- **Not** an issur de'oraita — provided food hasn't reached **ma'achal Ben Drosai** (minimum edibility: ~half-cooked or one-third cooked)
- Once it reaches ma'achal Ben Drosai → definitely violated Torah prohibition
- If it hasn't:
- **Have** violated a rabbinic prohibition — never allowed to leave something where it can reach yad soledet bo
- **What to do:** Take off immediately, before ma'achal Ben Drosai → at least rectify de'oraita

For Liquids

- Major discussion: what is ma'achal Ben Drosai for liquids?
- Is it half of yad soledet bo? One-third?
- Some poskim: concept of ma'achal Ben Drosai doesn't apply to liquids at all — only solid food
- Rabbi Kada noted he hasn't reviewed this recently but there is significant debate

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Davar Gush — The Maharshal's Chiddush (Mishnah Berurah, Seif Tet)

The Concept (Not Found in the Rishonim)

Liquids:

- When transferred between vessels → temperature genuinely decreases
- Particles move and disperse, transferring heat to new vessel's walls
- Kli sheni is genuinely cooler → the transfer makes a real difference

Solids (davar gush):

- A solid mass (boiling hot potato, chunk of meat, kugel) retains heat regardless of vessel
- Heat trapped inside the solid → doesn't dissipate by moving to a new plate
- A boiling hot potato on your plate = still effectively a **kli rishon**
- Full cooking ability, regardless of second plate, third plate, tenth plate

Practical Implications

Community	Position	Practical Result
Ashkenazim (Mishnah Berurah)	Machmir like Maharshal	Cannot put salt, butter, spices on a hot potato until it cools below yad soledet bo — regardless of how many plates
Sefardim (Chacham Ovadia)	Do NOT accept davar gush	Hot solid on second plate = kli sheni; third plate = kli shlishi. Regular rules apply.

Rabbi Kada's observation from yeshiva: "I remember in yeshiva they wouldn't put anything on potatoes. You had to wait until it wasn't hot anymore." — Ashkenazi practice following the Maharshal.

Key Practical Summary

1. **Yad soledet bo:** 45°C–71°C. On Shabbat: if you can't eat/drink it freely → yad soledet bo
2. **Stacking pots:** May place hot pot on top of another (even one on fire) and cover together — intervening pot = hefsek, better than garuf v'katum
3. **Food on an urn:** Dry cooked solids → always fine. Hot liquids (yad soledet bo) → fine. Cold liquids → only if urn surface can't bring to yad soledet bo
4. **Kli rishon off fire:** Still cooks — but cannot cook ox meat or salt (Shulchan Aruch)
5. **Salt:** Sefardim → kli rishon off fire freely. Ashkenazim → main halacha permits, praiseworthy to avoid even kli sheni
6. **Irui kli rishon:** Forbidden de'oraita (Rabbeinu Tam). Never pour from urn directly onto uncooked items
7. **Kli sheni doesn't cook:** Walls not heated by fire (Tosfot)
8. **Near the fire:** Only where it cannot reach yad soledet bo. Even momentary placement in a hotter spot = forbidden
9. **Dry cooked solids near fire:** Always permitted — even fully cooled, even if can reach yad soledet bo
10. **Davar gush:** Ashkenazim → hot solids retain kli rishon status. Sefardim → do not accept

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Preview: Next Shiur

- **Seifim י"א–י"ב:** Tata'ah gavar / ila'ah gavar — hot meets cold, which dominates?
- **Seif י"ז:** Congealed liquids melting on Shabbat
- **Seif י"ח:** Stirring pots on Shabbat (הגסה) — important practical point many aren't aware of

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Shabbat Shalom

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